

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly cloudy, a spotty shower, windy, high 74. **Tonight**, clear, light winds, low 62. **Tomorrow**, abundant sunshine, light winds, high 78. Weather map, Page 32.

VOL. CLXXV . . . No. 60,999

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SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 6, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00



NEETA SATAM FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Looking for Adventure on America’s ‘Mother Road’
Bikers from Europe on Route 66 in Stanton, Mo. The road has experienced an influx of foreign visitors. Sunday Business, Page 4.

In Ukraine, Fraud Is Rewarded With More Weapons Contracts

This article is by Andrew E. Kramer, Bianca Pallaro and Evelina Ribbenko.

KYIV, Ukraine — As Russian soldiers attacked trench lines in eastern Ukraine in 2024, Ukrainian artillery crews opened fire. But the rounds, instead of exploding near the advancing troops, flopped out of launch tubes or landed with quiet thumps, kicking up puffs of dust.

A Ukrainian arms factory, it turned out, had supplied the military with thousands of defective mortar rounds. A burly weapons factory boss, Leonid Shyman, would eventually be arrested and

charged in one of the war’s most public examples of defense-industry fraud.

But even as the officials noticed that weapons being received were faulty, government audits obtained by The New York Times show, Ukraine’s Defense Procurement Agency continued to award Mr. Shyman’s factory new contracts.

The case reflects a persistent phenomenon of the war in Ukraine. Seven of Ukraine’s top 10 military contractors won new business despite open criminal investigations for fraud, failures to deliver on earlier deals, or the arrest of chief executives for corruption, according to the government

Secret Military Audits Find Flawed System Enriches Suppliers

audits obtained by The Times, court records and Ukrainian news accounts.

Mr. Shyman, for example, had been the subject of multiple investigations by anti-corruption agencies, including for embezzlement and fraud, when he won that first mortar contract. The government awarded the \$280 million deal while he was out on bail.

Confidential reviews by the

State Audit Service and an internal Ministry of Defense auditing department reveal a military procurement system riddled with mismanagement. Warning signs go unheeded, the records show, and there are seldom consequences for overcharging or failing to deliver.

Companies won contracts without demonstrating that they could supply the weapons, or without licenses to deliver them. Auditors identified 18 companies that signed deals despite defaulting on previous agreements. Six of those failed to fulfill a single contract.

Military contractors around the globe, including the world’s rich-

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Mayor Enlists Friendly Army Of Influencers

By SALLY GOLDENBERG and EMMA GOLDBERG

On the morning of March 25, a flood of posts that struck a remarkably similar tone began popping up on scattered social media sites.

Mayor Zohran Mamdani had just decided to cancel a \$9 million contract that New York City had with the consulting giant McKinsey, and gushing praise came pouring in from commentators, operatives on the left and even some comedians.

Alex Jacquez, who works at a progressive think tank, posted on X: “Really exciting that NYC is generating operational efficiencies by in-sourcing needlessly outsourced public services and functions, building city capacity. More of this!”

Akilah Hughes, a comedian with more than 200,000 followers on X, reposted a comment suggesting that Mr. Mamdani was an improvement over his predecessor, Eric Adams, who “paid McKinsey \$16 million to research trash cans.”

Matt Stoller, a political commentator with more than 160,000 followers on X, wrote effusively that the mayor “just cut a \$9 million contract that McKinsey has with NYC. And then brags about it publicly. More please.”

Some of the online adulation,

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NEPAL ARMY, VIA REUTERS

Alive After 10 Days Underground
A Chinese hydropower worker was one of two people rescued after flooding in Nepal. Page 10.

Plan Would Shift Some Aid Meant for Working Parents to Stay-at-Home Spouses

By CORAL DAVENPORT

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is moving to allow married couples with a stay-at-home spouse to collect child care subsidies, a policy championed by Vice President JD Vance, using funds from a federal program intended to assist working parents, according to people familiar with

the discussions.

The change would create the only federal subsidy to pay parents to stay home and raise their children, one of the most significant efforts to date by the Trump administration to harness federal funds to promote a traditional view of families.

To do so, officials are seeking to use a Health and Human Services

A Vance Priority to Push Traditional Families

Department fund that was created in the 1990s to help low-income and working-class parents afford child care so they could work or go to school.

Kenyans Wrote College Essays For Americans. Then Came A.I.

By ADAM SATARIANO and PAUL MOZUR

NAIROBI, Kenya — Teresios Bundi once symbolized the strange, life-changing opportunities the internet provided.

Hailing from a farming village in Kenya, Mr. Bundi moved to the capital, Nairobi, in 2011 to be the first in his family to attend university. There, a friend suggested he try a new online job: writing essays for cheating overseas college students.

His first assignment was a two-page essay on the health benefits of the Garcinia cambogia. It was a fruit he had never heard of, and an essay written for a student he didn’t know anything about. He earned \$7 for three hours of work.

“That was a lifeline for me, I needed the money,” Mr. Bundi, now 34, said in an interview in Nairobi. He added: “I could not sleep that night. I was ready to

burn the midnight oil.”

Mr. Bundi estimates he wrote more than 2,500 essays over the next 12 years, sometimes three a day.

Mr. Bundi didn’t know it then, but he was in the boom era of internet gig work. Newly wired to the global internet and hungry for jobs, well-educated youths from places like Kenya, the Philippines and India found opportunities in the crevices of the digital economy. They could make money online doing unglamorous tasks that others further up the economic ladder did not want to do.

Then A.I. arrived, and the good times ended.

In 2022, OpenAI released ChatGPT. At colleges worldwide, students made a simple calculation that has become more pro-

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INTERNATIONAL 4-15

Trump’s Name, Not His Style
A village of small prefab homes on the Israeli-controlled Golan Heights is named for the U.S. president but lacks the gilded Trump aesthetic. PAGE 4

Deploying Chemical Weapons
Leaked documents bolster claims that Sudan’s military developed and used toxic bombs in the civil war. PAGE 12

Silent Sentinels of City Life
The bollard is a symbol of the hardened landscape of the post-9/11 city. It is also used as street furniture. PAGE 18



ARTS & LEISURE
Connecting Through Curiosity
In concert halls or small gatherings, the cellist Yo-Yo Ma learns a lot by asking people questions. Bringing people together is what drives him. PAGE 4

SUNDAY OPINION
Ruxandra Teslo PAGE 6

SUNDAY STYLES

The Queen of Many Courts
By wearing a wide-ranging collection created by multiple designers, Naomi Osaka has done much to change the game of tennis fashion this year. PAGE 8

Gloria Steinem’s Glamour
Her glasses, hairdo, bell bottoms and hip-slung belts were a part of a larger message and a bigger cause. PAGE 3

REAL ESTATE
Learning to Live With Sharks
As great whites have moved into Massachusetts waters, Cape Cod has changed to make room for them. PAGE 6



SPECIAL SECTION
Urban Explorations
Comprehensive guides to eight major tourist cities, including Copenhagen, above, geared to a first-time visitor.

SUNDAY BUSINESS

More Housing? Not This Year.
A plan by billionaires to build a city, with thousands of homes, hit a legislative setback. “It’s just incredibly hard to do large projects in California.” PAGE 1

METROPOLITAN
The City’s Past Is Still Visible
Traces of New York’s layered histories can be found scattered throughout a contemporary urban landscape. You just need to look. PAGE 4

